

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION — PRACTICE EXAMINATION**CLASS IX • SOCIAL SCIENCE (SUBJECT CODE: 087) • ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27****SET B — ADVANCED HOTS & ANALYTICAL THINKING****CHAPTER 04: EARLY HUMANS AND BEGINNING OF CIVILISATION**

TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES

MAXIMUM MARKS: 25 MARKS

SERIES: CBS-IX-SST-SET-B-04

Student's Name: _____

Roll No.: _____

Class & Section: Class IX - _____

Date of Exam: _____

Invigilator's Sign: _____

General Instructions (SET B - Advanced HOTS & Analytical Thinking):

1. The question paper comprises **25 Higher Order Thinking Skills (HOTS) Questions** of **1 mark** each.
2. Designed to test **deep causal reasoning, critical source evaluation, constitutional mechanics, and economic analysis**.
3. All questions are compulsory. There is no negative marking for incorrect answers.
4. Darken the corresponding bubble on the **OMR Sheet** completely using a blue/black ballpoint pen.

 **ADVANCED HOTS INSTRUCTIONS:** Carefully analyze the socio-historical contexts, geomorphic cause-and-effect relationships, and constitutional principles before selecting your answer.

Q.1 Why did the transition from the Palaeolithic foraging economy to the Neolithic farming economy represent one of the most profound revolutions in human social history?

- (A) Agricultural food surpluses enabled permanent sedentary villages, demographic expansion, specialized division of labor, and complex social stratification
- (B) It caused all humans to cease speaking spoken languages
- (C) It resulted in the immediate creation of modern digital factories
- (D) It eliminated all diseases and biological mortality instantly

Q.2 The sophisticated underground drainage system of Harappan cities (with brick cesspits, soak jars, and corbelled arched culverts) provides decisive evidence of:

- (A) A high level of centralized municipal governance, civic engineering foresight, and institutionalized public health and sanitation consciousness
- (B) An underground railway network for passenger trains
- (C) Unplanned accidental construction without intentional human design
- (D) A system designed exclusively to trap wild animals

Q.3 How does the urban layout of Dholavira in the Rann of Kutch differ fundamentally from most other excavated Harappan metropolitan centers like Harappa and Mohenjo-daro?

- (A) Dholavira was divided into three fortified sections (Citadel, Middle Town, and Lower Town) constructed largely of dressed stone masonry rather than fired bricks
- (B) Dholavira had no residential houses and was solely an animal cemetery
- (C) Dholavira was built completely on floating wooden boats
- (D) Dholavira lacked any defensive perimeter walls

Q.4 What engineering function was served by the monumental stone-and-masonry reservoirs interconnected by sluices and feeder canals discovered at Dholavira?

- (A) Sophisticated rainwater harvesting and storage designed to sustain an urban populace in an arid, drought-prone island environment
- (B) Breeding grounds for predatory saltwater sharks
- (C) Moats designed to drown visiting foreign trade ambassadors
- (D) Recreational swimming pools for royal yacht racing

Q.5 The discovery of an engineered brick tidal dockyard with sluice gates at Lothal on the Gulf of Khambhat demonstrates that the Harappans possessed:

- (A) Advanced hydro-engineering and navigational capabilities, functioning as a primary maritime trading portal linked to the Persian Gulf and Mesopotamia
- (B) Nuclear submarine warfare fleets
- (C) No understanding of tidal water cycles
- (D) A refusal to trade with any external foreign societies

Q.6 What does the extreme standardization of Harappan burnt brick dimensions (1:2:4 ratio in thickness, width, and length) across settlements spanning over 1,500 kilometers indicate?

- (A) The existence of shared metrological standards, coordinated craft guilds, and a highly organized administrative authority across the civilization
- (B) That every single brick was manufactured in one central factory in Harappa and transported by air
- (C) Pure random coincidence without any human planning
- (D) That bricks were imported directly from modern Europe

Q.7 Why were Harappan seals predominantly engraved with an animal motif alongside short pictographic inscriptions rather than extended narrative historical texts?

- (A) They functioned primarily as commercial marks of ownership, identity, and authority stamped onto clay tags (sealings) securing trade goods
- (B) Harappans did not know how to draw and could only carve animals
- (C) Seals were used exclusively as children's toy building blocks
- (D) Ancient laws prohibited writing more than three words

Q.8 In Harappan craft production, what was the significance of the bead-making factories discovered at Chanhudaro and Lothal?

- (A) They engaged in specialized mass production of luxury ornaments (carnelian, lapis lazuli, steatite) using sophisticated kiln-firing, drilling, and polishing technologies for internal and international trade
- (B) They manufactured glass sunglasses for kings
- (C) They produced copper cannonballs for military sieges
- (D) They made plastic jewelry for agricultural animals

Q.9 What analytical inference do archaeologists draw from the absence of monumental royal palaces, grandiose royal tombs, or standing armies in the archaeological record of Harappan cities?

- (A) Governance may have been based on civic consensus, merchant oligarchies, or shared municipal leadership rather than absolute, despotic divine kingship
- (B) Harappan cities had zero government or rules of any kind
- (C) The civilization was ruled by foreign kings living in Egypt
- (D) The population consisted entirely of hermit monks

Q.10 Which metallurgical discovery from Mohenjo-daro highlights the mastery of the 'lost-wax' (cire perdue) casting technique in Harappan art?

- (A) The bronze figurine of the 'Dancing Girl'
- (B) The limestone bust of the 'Priest-King'
- (C) The terracotta ploughed field furrow
- (D) The steatite unicorn seal

Q.11 What does the discovery of Harappan seals and etched carnelian beads in Mesopotamian archaeological sites (such as Ur, Kish, and Susa) historically prove?

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| (A) Active and regular long-distance maritime and overland commercial trade connections between the Indus Valley (Meluhha) and Mesopotamia | (B) A military invasion and conquest of Mesopotamia by Harappan soldiers |
| (C) That Mesopotamia was founded by Harappan refugees | (D) That Mesopotamians did not produce any pottery of their own |

Q.12 What critical agricultural tool was discovered in fired terracotta model form at the Harappan site of Banawali in Haryana?

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|--|------------------------------------|
| (A) A terracotta model of a plough | (B) A mechanical combine harvester |
| (C) A bronze sickle for harvesting wheat | (D) A stone irrigation pump |

Q.13 Why was the Great Bath at Mohenjo-daro waterproofed with a thick layer of natural bitumen (asphalt) between layers of fired brick and gypsum mortar?

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| (A) To prevent pool water from seeping through porous brickwork into the foundations of the Citadel and avoid groundwater infiltration | (B) To make the water completely poisonous to enemies |
| (C) To turn the pool water into black ink for writing | (D) To heat the bathing water through chemical reactions |

Q.14 Which of the following sites represents a major Harappan craft workshop specialized in processing marine conch shells into bangles, ladles, and inlays?

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|---------------------------|----------------|
| (A) Balakot and Nageshwar | (B) Shortughai |
| (C) Kalibangan | (D) Rakhigarhi |

Q.15 What does the unique double-furrow ploughed field discovered at Kalibangan indicate regarding Harappan agricultural practices?

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| (A) The simultaneous cultivation of two different complementary crops (like mustard and gram) in intersecting perpendicular furrows without shading each other | (B) That farming was practiced exclusively during midnight hours |
| (C) That Harappans only farmed on dry sand dunes without water | (D) That agriculture was performed without any seeds |

Q.16 How does the 'Priest-King' sculpture discovered at Mohenjo-daro suggest religious or elite authority?

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| (A) The seated steatite figure wears a patterned trefoil shawl draped over the left shoulder, an armlet, and a headband with a central circular medallion | (B) He holds a modern printed constitution in his right hand |
| (C) He wears a medieval European royal gold crown | (D) He is depicted flying across the sky on a mythical dragon |

Q.17 The Harappans established an isolated, fortified trading outpost at Shortughai in Badakhshan, northern Afghanistan. What primary strategic resource were they extracting?

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|--|-------------------------|
| (A) Lapis Lazuli (precious deep-blue metamorphic rock) | (B) Petroleum crude oil |
| (C) Natural rubber | (D) Fine silk cloth |

Q.18 Why do historians and linguists find it challenging to decipher the Indus script despite over 4,000 surviving inscriptions?

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| (A) The texts are brief (averaging ~5 signs), there is no bilingual inscription (like the Rosetta Stone), and the underlying language family remains unconfirmed | (B) The inscriptions were erased deliberately by colonial rulers |
| (C) The script was written exclusively in digital binary code | (D) All Harappan seals were destroyed in a fire |

Q.19 What does the discovery of copper mirrors, ivory combs, and small cosmetic terracotta jars containing antimony (kohl) in Harappan graves reveal about daily life?

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| (A) A cultural appreciation for personal grooming, hygiene, aesthetics, and belief in an afterlife where personal items accompanied the deceased | (B) That Harappans had no sense of personal hygiene |
| (C) That mirrors were used exclusively as lethal weapons in battle | (D) That burial was prohibited across all Indus settlements |

Q.20 Which Harappan urban center currently ranks as the largest excavated site of the civilization by geographical area (~350 hectares)?

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|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| (A) Rakhigarhi (Haryana) | (B) Mohenjo-daro (Sindh) |
| (C) Lothal (Gujarat) | (D) Banawali (Haryana) |

Q.21 What ecological and hydrological evidence supports the hypothesis that climatic shifts contributed to the decline of the mature Harappan urban phase?

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| (A) The gradual drying up and eastward tectonic diversion of the Ghaggar-Hakra (Saraswati) river system and weakening of the Indian summer monsoon | (B) A sudden cooling of the sun that froze the equator into a glacier |
| (C) The eruption of massive basalt volcanoes that covered Punjab in lava | (D) A massive flood that washed the subcontinent into the Atlantic ocean |

Q.22 What happened to Harappan material culture during the 'Late Harappan' phase (c. 1900–1300 BCE)?

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| (A) De-urbanization: standard weights, script, seals, and monumental brick architecture disappeared, shifting into localized rural regional agrarian cultures | (B) Cities expanded five-fold into modern industrial metropolises |
| (C) The population built giant stone pyramids across Punjab | (D) All humans abandoned the Indian subcontinent entirely |

Q.23 Which distinctive artifact found in Harappan excavations features a seated horned yogic figure surrounded by an elephant, a tiger, a rhinoceros, and a buffalo?

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| (A) The 'Pashupati' / Proto-Shiva seal | (B) The Dancing Girl bronze figurine |
| (C) The Dholavira sign-board | (D) The Great Granary stone model |

Q.24 Why was the discovery of fire during the Palaeolithic period a foundational milestone for early hominid evolution?

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|--|--|
| (A) It provided warmth in glacial cold, offered defense against nocturnal predators, enabled cooking of food (enhancing caloric absorption and brain growth), and provided light | (B) It allowed early humans to manufacture jet aircraft |
| (C) It eliminated all winter seasons from the planet Earth | (D) It enabled early humans to build high-rise skyscrapers |

Q.25 What primary socio-economic characteristic distinguished the Mesolithic culture from the preceding Upper Palaeolithic culture in India?

- (A) The development of microlithic composite tools (hafted onto bone/wood handles) and early stages of animal management alongside broader hunting-foraging
- (B) The invention of automated electric textile looms
- (C) The exclusive consumption of cultivated rice and wheat
- (D) The total abandonment of stone tools in favor of titanium

CBSE CANDIDATE OMR ANSWER RESPONSE GRID (SET B)

01	(A) (B) (C) (D)	02	(A) (B) (C) (D)	03	(A) (B) (C) (D)	04	(A) (B) (C) (D)	05	(A) (B) (C) (D)
06	(A) (B) (C) (D)	07	(A) (B) (C) (D)	08	(A) (B) (C) (D)	09	(A) (B) (C) (D)	10	(A) (B) (C) (D)
11	(A) (B) (C) (D)	12	(A) (B) (C) (D)	13	(A) (B) (C) (D)	14	(A) (B) (C) (D)	15	(A) (B) (C) (D)
16	(A) (B) (C) (D)	17	(A) (B) (C) (D)	18	(A) (B) (C) (D)	19	(A) (B) (C) (D)	20	(A) (B) (C) (D)
21	(A) (B) (C) (D)	22	(A) (B) (C) (D)	23	(A) (B) (C) (D)	24	(A) (B) (C) (D)	25	(A) (B) (C) (D)

Total Questions Attempted: ____ / 25

Marks Obtained: ____ / 25

Evaluator's Signature: _____

OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & STEP-BY-STEP EXPLANATIONS (SET B)

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Reference & Analytical Rationale
Q.1	(A)	V. Gordon Childe coined the 'Neolithic Revolution' because food production created economic surpluses that freed segments of society to become artisans, administrators, and builders.
Q.2	(A)	Standardized covered drains connecting private washrooms to street sumps reflect sophisticated municipal planning and public health standards unmatched in antiquity.
Q.3	(A)	Most Indus cities had a dual layout (Citadel and Lower Town) built of fired brick; Dholavira exhibited a unique tripartite design constructed of dressed stone masonry.
Q.4	(A)	Located in arid Kutch with seasonal monsoon rivulets (Mansar and Manhar), Dholavira engineered massive rock-cut reservoirs to harvest and conserve rainwater.
Q.5	(A)	Lothal's basin, linked to the Bhogavo river, regulated water levels via sluices to berth maritime vessels, confirmed by Persian Gulf seals and terracotta ship models.
Q.6	(A)	Uniform 1:2:4 brick proportions from Shortughai in Afghanistan to Lothal in Gujarat confirm centralized civic regulations and widespread standard metrology.
Q.7	(A)	Clay sealings from Lothal showing knot and fabric impressions on the reverse prove seals were pressed into damp clay over bundled goods to authenticate ownership.
Q.8	(A)	Chanhudaro and Lothal had specialized bead workshops where carnelian was baked to produce deep red colors, drilled with specialized chert drills, and polished for export.
Q.9	(A)	Unlike Egypt's Pharaohs or Mesopotamia's Lugal, the Indus civilization lacks dynastic megaliths or militaristic trophies, pointing toward a merchant/civic oligopoly.
Q.10	(A)	The Dancing Girl is a hollow-cast bronze masterpiece made via the lost-wax method, demonstrating sophisticated metallurgy and naturalistic aesthetic posture.
Q.11	(A)	Indus seals, cubed chert weights, and carnelian beads in Mesopotamian royal tombs match Akkadian texts recording trade with Meluhha, Magan, and Dilmun.
Q.12	(A)	The terracotta plough model from Banawali (alongside ploughed furrow grids at Kalibangan) confirms that Harappans utilized ox-drawn wooden ploughs.
Q.13	(A)	Gypsum mortar bound the fired bricks, and a 3-cm lining of natural bitumen (asphalt) sealed the pool, demonstrating waterproofing mastery.
Q.14	(A)	Nageshwar (Gujarat) and Balakot (Pakistan) were coastal shell-working industrial centers situated near rich marine conch beds (*Turbinella pyrum*).
Q.15	(A)	Two sets of furrows crossing at right angles (narrow furrows for horsegram, wide furrows for mustard) demonstrate sophisticated mixed-cropping techniques.
Q.16	(A)	The introspective, slit-eyed steatite bust of the 'Priest-King' with a trefoil-patterned robe resembles elite Mesopotamian religious and civic portraiture.
Q.17	(A)	Shortughai was established along the Oxus River specifically to control the mining and trade of rare, highly prized Lapis Lazuli from Badakhshan.
Q.18	(A)	Lacking bilingual parallel texts (like the Greek-Egyptian Rosetta Stone) and dealing with short inscriptions, epigraphists cannot definitively map phonemes.
Q.19	(A)	Cosmetic artifacts in inhumation burials reflect vanity, refined body care, specialized metal polishing, and religious conceptions of post-mortem existence.

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Reference & Analytical Rationale
Q.20	(A)	Excavations at Rakhigarhi in Haryana show a vast cluster of mounds spanning over 350 hectares, confirming it as the largest known Indus metropolis.
Q.21	(A)	Paleoclimate studies show weakened summer monsoons after 2000 BCE and drying of the Ghaggar-Hakra system, causing urban de-densification and eastward rural migration.
Q.22	(A)	The Late Harappan phase saw the collapse of centralized civic institutions, long-distance trade, and writing, giving way to rural squatter settlements.
Q.23	(A)	The Pashupati seal from Mohenjo-daro depicts a three-faced horned deity in yogic posture flanked by four wild beasts, interpreted by Sir John Marshall as proto-Shiva.
Q.24	(A)	Control of fire expanded the human niche: cooked food softened fibers and denatured toxins, drastically improving hominid energy intake and survival.
Q.25	(A)	The post-glacial Holocene Mesolithic saw smaller geometric microliths hafted as arrowheads and sickles, alongside early faunal domestication.